

EDWIN KASILA

PROJECT & PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT PROFESSIONAL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Project and Programme Management Professional with over five years of experience coordinating complex research, monitoring and evaluation, and technology-driven initiatives across international development, research, and private sector environments. Experienced in leading cross-functional teams, managing stakeholder relationships, coordinating field operations, and supporting data-driven decision-making for organizations including the **World Bank Group**, **World Food Programme (WFP)**, **University of California, Berkeley**, and **Echo Mobile**. Passionate about leveraging technology, data, and emerging AI solutions to improve operational efficiency and deliver meaningful social impact. Recognized for strong leadership, adaptability, and the ability to translate strategic objectives into successful project execution.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Program Field Coordinator, Development Impact Evaluation (DIME) & UNWFP

09/2019 - 08/2024

World Bank Group & WFP • Nairobi, Isiolo

Served in a pivotal role orchestrating high-impact development research and rigorous impact evaluations across Kenya. Translated complex academic and experimental monitoring & evaluation (M&E) research designs into actionable, field-level implementation strategies. Cultivated robust collaborations with local government authorities, international agency implementing partners, and the World Bank research team. Directed field-level operations, supervised community mobilization initiatives, managed multi-tier data collection processes, monitored digital cash transfers, and served as the primary multi-stakeholder communication hub.

CORE RESPONSIBILITIES:

- Led large-scale mobile data collection activities, community mobilization campaigns, and field staff training; implemented rigorous end-to-end data management protocols and systematic back-checks to safeguard data integrity.
- Formulated and executed strategic beneficiary mobilization frameworks across multiple project phases, optimizing community buy-in and maximizing participation in development initiatives.
- Monitored ground-level project execution continuously, proactively identifying structural threats to experimental design and collaborating with principal investigators to approve and deploy real-time operational course-corrections.
- Liaised as the central focal point and trusted advisor between diverse project stakeholders (local/county governments, WFP, and the World Bank Group), presenting key evaluation metrics to drive evidence-based decision-making.
- Orchestrated comprehensive onboarding, technical training, and day-to-day coordination for multidisciplinary project implementation staff and field enumerators.
- Established unified communication channels between executive project directorates and field coordination teams, eliminating bottlenecks and driving operational excellence.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Successfully coordinated multiple impact evaluations while consistently meeting project quality standards and implementation timelines.
- Optimized stakeholder engagement and reporting efficiency by developing streamlined communication matrices for international and local counterparts.
- Introduced structured monitoring workflows and reporting processes that strengthened data quality assurance and improved communication between field and research teams.
- Led the translation and localization of data collection instruments and training materials, ensuring accuracy, consistency, and alignment with local community contexts.

Consultant Project Manager

02/2019 - 12/2022

Echo Mobile • Nairobi

As Deployment Team Lead within Echo Mobile's consulting division, I led a collaborative project with researchers from the University of California, Berkeley focused on improving road safety within Kenya's matatu industry. The project involved deploying vehicle sensor technology and mobile data collection tools to generate evidence that informed passenger safety ratings and road safety research.

CORE RESPONSIBILITIES:

- Designed and coordinated the implementation of SMS/USSD-based mobile surveys to capture passenger feedback, collaborating with UC Berkeley researchers to support road safety analysis.
- Collaborated on experimental research designs, piloting new hardware treatments and tracking algorithms using advanced vehicle telematics to optimize raw safety metrics.
- Managed project budgets and critical-path timelines, preparing executive briefs, financial reconciliations, and milestone progress reports for international donors and senior leadership.
- Negotiated and managed strategic relationships with senior executives of transport SACCOs (minibus cooperatives), municipal planning boards, and regulatory authorities.
- Supervised technical deployment teams in installing, configuring, and maintaining onboard telematics and GPS trackers across participating public transport SACCO vehicles within the project.
- Recruited, trained, and led a high-performing team of field enumerators and community advocates executing data collection and public road safety campaigns.
- Supported quantitative research streams by cleaning, organizing, and analyzing telemetry databases using Excel, R, and statistical toolkits.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Secured unprecedented industry buy-in from fragmented transit stakeholders, onboarding top-tier transport cooperatives to participate in the experimental pilot.
- Exercised decisive leadership in high-pressure environments, maintaining project continuity amidst volatile transit strikes and operational challenges.
- Delivered all critical project milestones within tight budgetary constraints, exceeding international data collection quality benchmarks.
- Co-authored the project's comprehensive data governance framework, transforming millions of telemetry data points into actionable public safety recommendations.
- Implemented structured risk-tracking and progress dashboards, providing high-frequency visibility into operational risks for international stakeholders.

Research Project Manager

02/2019 - 12/2022

University of California, Berkeley (UCB) Economics Research • Nairobi

Led the execution of two large-scale experimental economic research projects in direct partnership with Jumia (Africa's largest e-commerce ecosystem) and UC Berkeley. Investigated merchant onboarding dynamics, micro-enterprise growth, and digital customer support interactions to understand operational levers for small business success in emerging digital economies.

CORE RESPONSIBILITIES:

- Coordinated end-to-end research pipelines, integrating daily data collection with rigorous quality assurance checks and exploratory data analysis using R, Python, and Excel.
- Built and maintained strong operational relationships with Jumia Kenya stakeholders to facilitate secure data sharing, survey integrations, and effective project execution.
- Analyzed transactional and behavioural data from thousands of onboarded SMEs, drafting strategic briefs on digital adoption and business performance.
- Designed and deployed custom randomized-controlled-trial (RCT) chatbot/chat plugin test environments, analyzing customer support interactions to isolate behavioral friction points.

- Collaborated directly with UC Berkeley Principal Investigators to synthesize research insights, draft academic working papers, and prepare reports for global funding foundations.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Built and maintained strong working relationships between the UC Berkeley research team and Jumia Kenya, helping establish effective collaboration and data-sharing processes throughout the project.
- Supported data cleaning, validation, and analysis using R and Excel, improving the efficiency and quality of project reporting.
- Coordinated randomized controlled trial (RCT) activities across several thousand merchants, ensuring high-quality participation and data integrity throughout the study.
- Upskilled and managed a dedicated team of 15+ research assistants, ensuring 100% compliance with strict human subjects protection (IRB) guidelines.
- Introduced advanced econometric matching and sub-group analysis methodologies, uncovering critical insights about gender-based customer service interactions.
- Contributed to the preparation of research findings and reports presented to Jumia management, supporting operational decision-making and project planning.
- Fostered a highly collaborative, inclusive research culture that sustained morale and exceptional quality standards across multi-year project lifecycles.

SELECTED PERSONAL PROJECTS

PortfolioOS [\(In Development\)](#)

Designing and developing **PortfolioOS**, a modular portfolio website and lightweight content management platform built with Astro. The project explores modern software architecture, responsive UI design, JSON-driven content management, and AI-assisted workflows while strengthening my software engineering, product management, and digital product development skills. The platform is designed to evolve into a scalable professional portfolio and personal content management system.

Project Nuru [\(In Development\)](#)

Leading the design and product strategy for **Project Nuru**, a digital mental wellbeing platform exploring responsible applications of AI to improve access to affordable mental health support. Responsible for product planning, requirements definition, user experience design, and technical architecture while researching scalable, user-centered solutions tailored to the African context.

Personal Development Platform [\(In Development\)](#)

Contributing to the design and planning of an AI-assisted personal development platform focused on goal tracking, habit formation, journaling, and productivity. Supporting product strategy, feature planning, user experience design, and systems thinking while exploring practical applications of AI to encourage personal growth and long-term engagement.

EDUCATION

BSc Information Technology (IT)

2013 - 2017

Multimedia University of Kenya

Cisco Certified Networking Associate (CCNA)

2016

Multimedia University of Kenya

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Google Project Management Professional Certificate (Continuous Learning)
- Project Management Institute (PMI) Learning Path (In Progress)
- Amazon Web Services (AWS) Cloud Fundamentals (In Progress)
- Continuous learning in Artificial Intelligence, Digital Product Management, and Modern Software Development

TECHNICAL & FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

CORE COMPETENCIES

Project Management | Research Coordination | Stakeholder Engagement | M&E | Strategic Planning | Team Leadership | Data Collection & Quality Assurance

DATA & TECHNOLOGY

Python | R | Power BI | SQL (Basic) | Git/GitHub | JavaScript | Microsoft Office | SurveyCTO & KoboToolbox | VS Code | Google Workspace

EMERGING TECHNOLOGIES

AI-assisted Workflows | Prompt Engineering | Product Strategy | Digital Product Development | Software Architecture (Learning) | Workflow Automation (Learning)